

SUN, WIND, AND RAIN

Heavy rain might make us very wet, but it also washes away bare soil. Soils need plants to protect them from all kinds of weather, from splashy rains to burning sunshine and howling winds!



Whirling columns of air and soil are called dust devils.

Baked dry

Dry soil is kept in place by plants. If bare soil is baked dry by the sun, wind can blow it away.

Plant leaves can protect the soil from raindrops.

Plant roots hold soil in place.

Splashed away

A drop of rain can be bad for soil. Raindrops hitting the ground with lots of force dislodge soil particles and wash them away.

Muddy Floods

Soil on hilly land without plant roots to anchor it in place is in danger. Too much rain causes floods that can wash the soil away.